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ShopSmart Electronics — Product Category Reference Guide

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> This guide defines how products are assigned to categories. Category assignment determines the applicable return window, restocking fee, loyalty point multiplier and shipping restrictions. When a customer question concerns a specific product, resolve its category first, then apply the category rule.

1. Why Category Matters

The return window, restocking fee and shipping treatment all follow from the product's category, not from its price or brand. A $1,399 smartphone has a 15-day return window while a $99 computer mouse has 45 days, because the categories differ. Resolving the category is therefore the first step in answering any return eligibility question.

Category	Return Window	Restocking Fee	Points Multiplier
Smartphones & Tablets	15 days	None	1x (2x Premium)
Laptops & Computers	30 days	15% on desktops/workstations only	1x (2x Premium)
Audio & Headphones	30 days	None	1x (3x Premium)
Televisions & Monitors	15 days	15% on TVs over 55 inches	1x (2x Premium)
Cameras & Photography	30 days	15% on drones	1x (2x Premium)
Gaming Consoles	15 days	None	1x (2x Premium)
Gaming Accessories	30 days	None	1x (2x Premium)
Smart Home Devices	30 days	None	1x (2x Premium)
Wearables & Fitness	30 days	None	1x (2x Premium)
Computer Accessories	45 days	None	1x (2x Premium)
Cables & Adapters	45 days	None	1x (2x Premium)
Software & Digital Codes	Non-returnable	—	1x
Gift Cards	Non-returnable	—	None

2. Category Definitions

2.1 Smartphones & Tablets

Mobile phones, tablets and e-readers with a cellular or Wi-Fi primary function. Includes iPhone, Galaxy, Pixel, iPad and similar devices in all storage configurations.

Does **not** include: smartwatches (see Wearables & Fitness), phone cases and screen protectors (see Computer Accessories), or charging cables sold separately (see Cables & Adapters).

The 15-day window is shorter than most categories because of the high rate of fraudulent swaps in this category. Returns in this category require the original IMEI or serial number to match the record on the order.

2.2 Laptops & Computers

Portable and desktop computing devices: laptops, notebooks, convertibles, desktop towers, all-in-one machines, mini PCs and workstations.

The 15% restocking fee applies only to **desktop computers and workstations** when opened, not to laptops. Laptops carry no restocking fee at any time. Custom-configured and built-to-order machines in this category are non-returnable except when defective, because they cannot be resold.

2.3 Audio & Headphones

Headphones, earbuds, portable and smart speakers, soundbars, receivers, amplifiers, turntables and microphones.

Soundbars are classified here rather than under Televisions & Monitors, so a soundbar carries a 30-day window rather than 15 days even when purchased alongside a television. A television and soundbar bought together as a bundle, however, take the bundle rule: the shortest component window, which is 15 days.

2.4 Televisions & Monitors

Televisions of any size, computer monitors, projectors and projection screens.

The 15% restocking fee applies to opened televisions **over 55 inches** only. A 55-inch television incurs no restocking fee; a 65-inch television does. Monitors of any size incur no restocking fee. Items in this category with a screen over 40 inches require scheduled pickup rather than carrier return, incurring the large-item pickup fee where the return is non-defective.

2.5 Cameras & Photography

Mirrorless and DSLR cameras, lenses, action cameras, drones, gimbals, tripods, lighting and camera bags.

The 15% restocking fee applies to **drones and aerial equipment** only. Lenses and camera bodies carry no restocking fee. Drones additionally face shipping restrictions: units with batteries over 100Wh cannot be shipped by air to certain international destinations.

2.6 Gaming Consoles

Game consoles, handheld gaming systems and console bundles sold as a single SKU.

The 15-day window matches Smartphones & Tablets and reflects the same fraud exposure. Console returns require the serial number to match the order record. Physical game discs and cartridges are classified under

Gaming Accessories; downloadable game codes are Software & Digital Codes and are non-returnable once revealed.

2.7 Gaming Accessories

Controllers, headsets marketed for gaming, racing wheels, flight sticks, charging docks, physical game discs and cartridges, and console storage expansion.

Note the overlap with Audio & Headphones: a gaming headset is classified as a Gaming Accessory, not as Audio & Headphones. Both carry a 30-day window, so the distinction does not affect return eligibility, but it does affect the Premium points multiplier — Audio & Headphones earns 3x for Premium Members while Gaming Accessories earns 2x.

2.8 Smart Home Devices

Smart displays, smart speakers with an assistant as the primary function, video doorbells, security cameras, smart locks, thermostats, smart lighting and hubs.

A smart speaker whose primary marketing is audio quality (for example a high-fidelity speaker with assistant support) is classified under Audio & Headphones. A device whose primary function is the assistant or home control is classified here. Both carry a 30-day window.

2.9 Wearables & Fitness

Smartwatches, fitness trackers, heart-rate monitors, smart rings, smart scales and connected fitness accessories.

Wearables that have been worn are inspected for hygiene and condition. Visible wear on a band or sensor surface may trigger the 70% condition deduction. Advise customers to retain the original bands and use a protective film during the evaluation period.

2.10 Computer Accessories

Keyboards, mice, webcams, docking stations, external drives, memory, laptop stands, cases, bags, screen protectors and surge protectors.

The 45-day window is the longest standard window offered and reflects the low fraud risk and high resalability of this category. Items must be in resalable condition; the original packaging is preferred but not strictly required, unlike most other categories.

2.11 Cables & Adapters

HDMI, USB, Thunderbolt, Ethernet and audio cables; power adapters; hubs; dongles and converters.

Cables carry a 45-day window but must be **unopened** to qualify for return. An opened cable is not returnable as a change-of-mind return. A cable that fails in use within the window is treated as defective and is returnable or replaceable regardless of packaging state. Cables fraying at the connector after extended use are classified as consumable wear and are not covered.

2.12 Software & Digital Codes

Downloadable software licences, subscription activation codes, digital game codes and digital gift content.

Non-returnable once the licence key or code has been revealed or redeemed. If a code has been delivered but demonstrably not redeemed, support may at supervisor discretion revoke the code and issue a refund — this is an exception, not an entitlement. A code that fails to activate due to a platform fault is replaced, not refunded.

2.13 Gift Cards

Physical and digital ShopSmart gift cards and prepaid cards. Non-returnable and non-refundable in all cases. See the Gift Cards, Store Credit & Promotions Policy for full terms.

3. Resolving Ambiguous Products

When a product could plausibly fall into two categories, apply these tie-breakers in order:

1. **The category recorded on the order record is authoritative.** Never re-derive a category from the product name when the order record states one.
2. If no order record is available, classify by **primary function**, not by form factor or marketing.
3. If primary function is genuinely ambiguous, apply the category with the **longer** return window, in the customer's favour.
4. Escalate to a supervisor if the ambiguity affects restocking fees above $50.

3.1 Common Ambiguities

Product	Correct Category	Not
Gaming headset	Gaming Accessories	Audio & Headphones
Soundbar	Audio & Headphones	Televisions & Monitors
Smart display with screen	Smart Home Devices	Televisions & Monitors
Smartwatch	Wearables & Fitness	Smartphones & Tablets
Tablet with detachable keyboard	Smartphones & Tablets	Laptops & Computers
Convertible laptop with touch screen	Laptops & Computers	Smartphones & Tablets
Phone case or screen protector	Computer Accessories	Smartphones & Tablets
External graphics enclosure	Computer Accessories	Laptops & Computers
Webcam	Computer Accessories	Cameras & Photography
Action camera	Cameras & Photography	Computer Accessories
Charging cable sold separately	Cables & Adapters	The device's category
Console bundled with a game	Gaming Consoles	Gaming Accessories

4. Contact

- **Category and policy questions:** 1-800-746-7762, option 8

- **Email:** policy@shopsmartelectronics.com
- **Hours:** Monday – Saturday, 8:00 AM – 10:00 PM EST; Sunday 10:00 AM – 8:00 PM EST